Mary Johnston Public School - School Council - Meeting Minutes

Wednesday, February 12, 2025

Start time: 6:34pm
Location: Virtual - Microsoft Teams

In Attendance:
Sarah Bester
Reza Ramezan
Bill Halford
Marcus Hoare
Amy Yardley
Nadia Deonarine
Adrienne Brown
Allison Hill
Amy Neilson
Andrea Labyt
Dianne Lapierre
Ehan Parvizi
Erika Bryant
Janice Taylor
Mark Hacking
Vivian Mirani

Qurum - Yes

Principal's Welcome - Marcus Hoare

- Marcus welcomes everyone. Talks about the Land acknowledgment.
- Teachers are starting to go to seminars on PD days. Stopped during COVID. Seminars include literacy, math, kindergarten classes, and Special Education information.
- Class photos- Life Touch can do class composites but not a group picture all together,
- There will be a Neurodiversity information night coming up soon. Look to School Day for more information.

Council Matters

Finances - **Sarah Bester**

- Holding back $5000.00 in account for last-minute asks.
- Approval for $500.00 for Literacy Night.
- Reza found a grant (Community Foundation Grant). It can be up to $5000.00 that can go towards a project. Will do more learning and let us know more when needed.

Funding Requests - Marcus

Track and Field -

- Requesting $300 for bus transportation
- One-time request for spring

Kodaly Choir

- Requesting $300 for bus transportation
- One-time trip; historically Council has covered the cost

MOTION to pay $600 for both buses
Moved by: Bill
Seconded: Reza
Motion passed

PALS

- Requesting $250
- PALS are older students who go out to play and entertain younger students
- Mrs Kaur and Mme Richmond oversee the MJ PALS program
- They run group games during Nutrition Breaks and invite as many younger kids as possible to join in
- Sometimes they connect with other PALS groups for a little "leadership conference"
- Funding request is to cover different equipment than what is currently available to help with activities

MOTION to cover $250 for PALS materials
Moved by: Reza
Seconded: Sarah
Motion passed

Outdoor Learning Centre

- Reza found a CP grant that may be helpful and will pursue an application for additional funding
- Marcus reached out to the grounds crew, and we have the go-ahead to explore options, map out ideas and start to develop plans
- We also have the green light from facilities (a facilities manager will visit MJ shortly)
- Next steps
    - Talk about where it can be built.
    - Need a sub-committee with specific roles. People interested: Reza, Janice, Marcus, Sarah, Amy Y, Kara

Fundraising Initiative Updates

Halo Car Wash - Vivian

- Would like to know where the $$ will be allocated. Outdoor learning space? NFL?
- Sparked a conversation about NFL.
- MOTION to allocate funds raised from the carwash to Outdoor Learning and Activities Fund (OLAF)
    - Moved by: Bill
    - Seconded by: Adrienne
    - Motion passed.

NFL

- Francine stepped down from NFL program. Administration is doing the work.
- Could we run our own NFL?
    - If MJ does run it's own NFL we still need to follow guidelines. Marcus would like to learn more about the current program to make an informed choice. Revisit in May meeting
    - Mark Hacking question: Could we work with other neighbouring schools? Can we shop at Zhers to get what we need?
    - Dianne: What is the feedback from teachers? How is the program going in the classrooms? Answer: The Boomerang program has helped with food waste with NFL. Kids aren't needing to use NFL as much.

Pizza

- Pizza is going well.
- Glove shortage. Amy N. will send Bill information about how much it costs for gloves.

Move-A-Thon

- Need to start thinking about buying glowsticks
- $450.00 already allocated to the event.
- Adrienne is concerned about the waste impact of the glow sticks. We might be sending mixed messages (The Boomerang Lunch program is about not being wasteful)
- Amy. Y suggested getting reusable toys and gadgets in addition to the leftover glow items from last year.
- Janice suggested white t- shirts and sharpies. Glow in the dark paint? Paint Mr. H? Should the funds from this event be allocated to OLAF? Is this the place to announce this initiative? Discussion: Undecided. We will re-visit this at the next meeting.
- Kara will put some thought into all of these ideas.

Table Literacy Night
Table End of Year

Dismissed at 8:04

Notable dates
Kindergarten night for incoming kindergarteners will be May 28th.

Next meeting: Wednesday, February 12th.